



YOUR GUIDE TO *home*

Jonathan Croco
BUY • SELL

JONATHAN CROCO | 443.319.3862 | CROCOREALESTATE.COM



Jonathan Croco
BUY • SELL • INVEST

REAL ESTATE AGENT

a little about me...

Real estate is my passion. From architecture to contract negotiation to investing, I love every aspect of it. A home is the foundation of a wonderful life and there is nothing better than helping someone buy and sell their home! I have lived and worked in areas all across the state for my entire life and capitalize on my extensive knowledge of these diverse communities to best serve my clients.

let's connect



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@jonthebreedengroup



MEET OUR *Team*



Jonathan
TEAM LEAD

Jonathan is the team lead and had done 100s of deals. He also renovates houses, is a landlord, does property management for clients and is getting his appraiser's license.



Ahmad
TRANSACTION
COORDINATOR

Ahmad is the transaction coordinator and handles the transaction fully once your contract is accepted. I am still your first point of contact for anything needed during this time.



Glenda
CLIENT CARE

Glenda is our Client Care Coordinator and focuses entirely on your overall experience beyond the paperwork. She is here to check in, answer day-to-day questions, and ensure you feel supported and heard through every step of your move.

MEET OUR *vendors*



Chris Marsiglia
LENDER

Chris is the Branch Manager for Secured Funding Corporation. Chris has over 15 years of experience, has closed 100s of deals, offers great rates, extensive market knowledge and fast communication!



David Miller
TERRAIN TITLE

David E. Miller is a Principal at Terrain Title & Escrow Company who specializes in providing efficient settlement services for residential and commercial real estate.



Brairwood Home
INSPECTOR

Briarwood Home does over 1000 home inspections each year. They have a truly unique attention to detail and even offer warranties on the inspections provided.

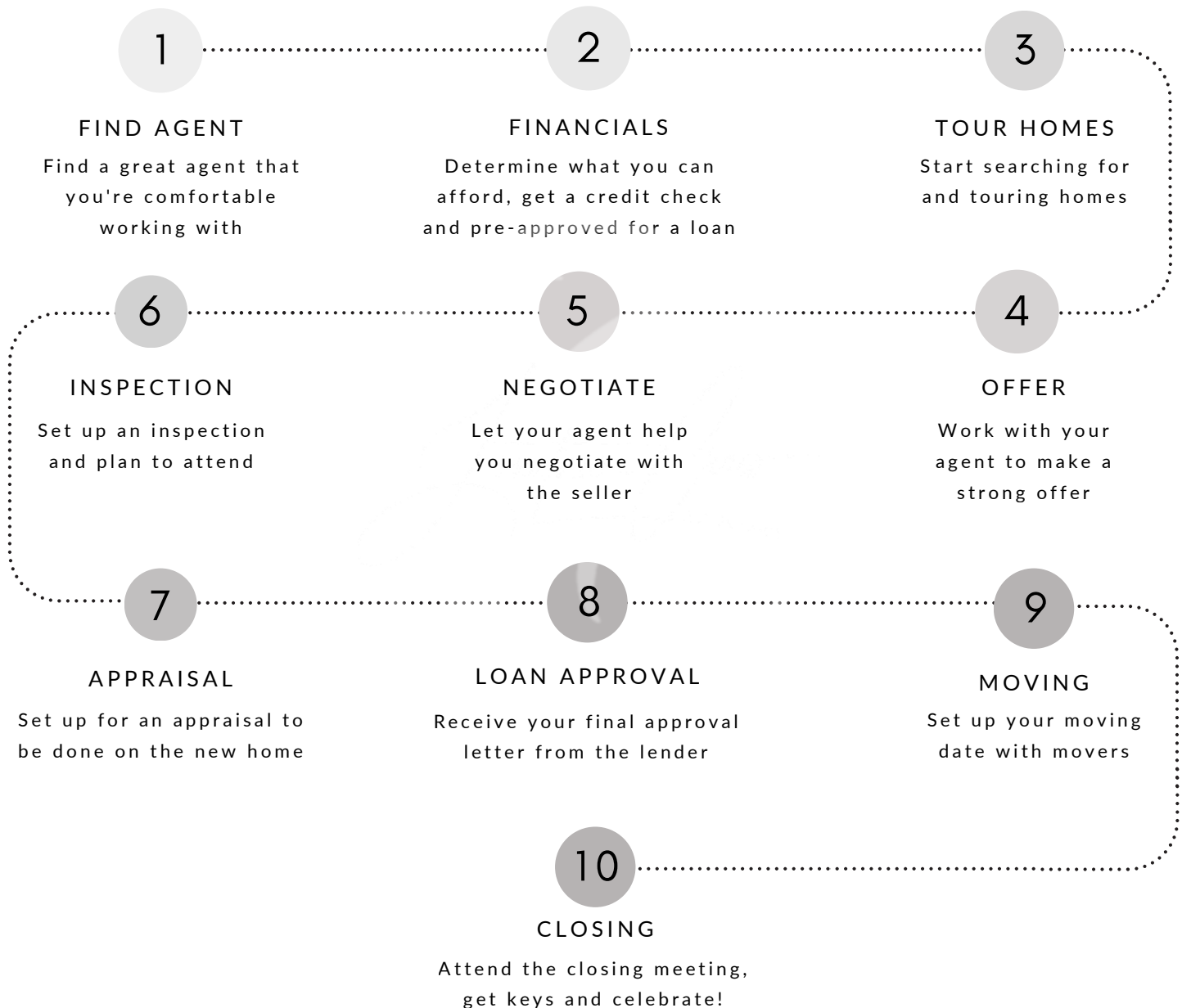


Anything else you need?
TBG HAS IT ALL!

The Breeden Group prides itself on its network and the professionals it chooses to work with. If you need a contractor or vendor of any kind, please feel free to reach out and we would be glad to help!

HOME BUYER'S *Roadmap*

Use this roadmap as a quick overview of the buying process. If you have any questions, please reach out to your realtor!



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REAL ESTATE *Terms*

PRE-APPROVAL

A pre-approval is a preliminary evaluation conducted by the lender to show that the buyer has the funds to purchase up to a certain amount. This is extremely helpful when you find a home you're ready to put an offer on.

OFFER V

RATIFIED CONTRACT

An agreement between a buyer and a seller to purchase a piece of real estate becomes ratified once returned signed from the seller.

CONTINGENCY

When an offer is accepted by the seller, but there are certain conditions that must be met before the sale is final.

CLOSING COST

The fees that are paid at the end of the purchase by either the buyer, seller or both. These include taxes, insurance and lender expenses.

EARNEST MONEY

Also known as "good faith" money, this is money put up by the buyer into a trust or escrow account. This action shows the buyer is serious about purchasing the home.

TITLE SEARCH

A title search proves that the property is, in fact, owned by the seller. You can also purchase title insurance to make that no issues that arise later.

APPRAISAL

The appraisal is the value given to a property based on comparable properties that have recently sold. This is typically required by the lender in order to decide if the requested loan amount is in alignment with the value of the property.

HOME INSPECTION

An inspection is a professional examination of the property's condition. Your agent can recommend a qualified home inspector for you.

DISCLOSURES

All seller's are required to fill out a property disclosure stating what they know about the property - good or bad.

CLOSING

This is the final step of your real estate transaction. At closing the funds from the buyer are provided to the seller and the buyer receives the keys. This process typically takes an hour.



REAL ESTATE IS AN
IMPERISHABLE ASSET, EVER
INCREASING IN VALUE. IT IS THE
MOST SOLID SECURITY THAT
HUMAN INGENUITY HAS DEVISED.
IT IS THE BASIS OF ALL SECURITY
AND ABOUT THE ONLY
INDESTRUCTIBLE SECURITY.



RUSSEL SAGE



ten steps to BUYING A HOME

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A dimly lit interior scene featuring a dark wooden table, a modern lamp, a framed abstract painting, and a light switch.

Preparing
to Buy

1

FINDING A GREAT AGENT

A real estate agent is a huge asset to you as you go through the home-buying process. This is one of the biggest decisions of your life and you need a skilled professional guiding you through the process.

Your agent will be working with your best interests in mind and can help guide you through all the stages of home buying.



Connect YOU WITH THE PERFECT HOME

Agents often have access to information about homes going on the market before the public. They can also arrange open houses and tours of homes that match your criteria.

Knowledge OF NEIGHBORHOOD

Agents will be able to offer insightful details about the neighborhoods you are considering.

Attention TO DETAIL

The process of buying a home requires attention to detail. From the neighborhood to the house to writing a contract, an industry professional will keep an eye on all the details.

Professional NEGOTIATOR

Agents deal with any difficult conversations that need to happen. They will also help you submit a strong offer and negotiate with the seller on your behalf.

Expert GUIDE

Realtors are there to help you with any questions you have along the way. They offer an objective opinion when you're analyzing the features you're looking for.

2

FINANCIALS

Online mortgage calculators are a great starting point but speaking to a local lender is best in determining your purchasing power and budget.

Basic Break down

- **Down Payment** - 3% min.
(20% to avoid PMI)
- **Closing Costs** - 4% avg.
(3-6% range)
(1% EMD with offer)
- **Transaction** - \$1500
 - Inspection - \$1000
 - Appraisal - \$500

There are three numbers to focus on when getting a mortgage: the money upfront (down payment and closing costs), the ongoing expense (mortgage), and the rate you charged for borrowing money (interest rate).





CREDIT CHECK

It is important to have a credit check done as this will be a factor in determining your mortgage approval and interest rates.

The national minimum is 580 but many lenders have a 640 minimum. Your interest rate will also lower with a higher credit score so entering credit repair **early** could save you money on your mortgage!

PRE-QUALIFIED & PRE-APPROVED

Receiving a pre-qualification from an online lender unfortunately is not sufficient. A pre-approval from a local lender will present best for a strong offer.

Banks tend to be slower to close as the communication is more difficult. Credit unions, while better than banks can still be unreliable. Local mortgage brokers referred from your trusted realtor will present the strongest and have the lowest rates!

This pre-approval does not guarantee a loan will be offered so you still want to be careful with your spending during this time. Don't make any large purchases, change jobs, move money or apply for new credit cards during this time.

Before our offer goes out, review the financials with your lender - taxes, HOA/Condo fees, etc. can greatly change the mortgage!

Finding a Home



3

TOUR HOMES

We will work together to create a search with all the criteria you are looking for in a home!

We can continue to amend this search to narrow in on the perfect home for you!



We will start touring homes and weigh all the positive and negative aspects of each one.

When you find THE house, your next step will be to make an offer and go through any negotiations.

Home searching tips.....

- Take notes. Take photos with your phone while visiting each house. Organize the photos at home with the address of the property so you can remember details later.
- Focus on the things you can't change like the neighborhood, lot or size of bedrooms. Don't buy the paint on the walls or the carpet on the floor.
- If you like the house, drive the neighborhood in an outward spiral. Google the closest grocery store, Target / Wal Mart, and look at the schools. These are the places you will go every day.
- Let's chat on foreclosures, short sales, REOs, and auctions...



4

MAKE AN OFFER

Once you've found the home you want, the next step is to make an offer. Before we do, we will review comparable properties (comps), speak with the listing agent and review any seller disclosures.

The number of offers, days on market, comps, and conversation with the listing agent all help in crafting a competitive offer.

The contract of sale in MD is standardized.

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NEGOTIATE OFFER

After the offer is presented, they can accept, counter-offer or decline the offer.

In a competitive market, be prepared to concede certain items to increase the strength of the offer. Sometimes having wiggle room is worth more than putting our best foot forward off the bat.



6

INSPECTION

It's always a good idea to add a contingency clause into your offer stating that you have a certain amount of time to have the property inspected although it is not always possible in a competitive situation. Sometimes the right to ask for repairs, the right to terminate or the right to have inspections at all is waived.



Plan to attend the inspection and be prepared to ask any questions you have.

You will receive a report of findings, but it's sometimes easier to see the issue and hear the information directly from the inspector.

After the inspection is complete, decide if there are any pressing issues you want to negotiate with the seller.

Inspections are limited. We are focusing first on safety concerns followed by functional concerns. Cosmetic issues are not addressed.

Aside from your inspection, your EMD and loan application will have to be completed the first week!



Final Steps

7

APPRAISAL



Your lender will require an appraisal of the home before finalizing the loan.

It's common for appraisals to come in on the nose. If it is high, yay! Equity! If it is low, we will have to negotiate a resolution.

A property title search will ensure that the sellers are truly the owners of the property and any liens or judgments are disclosed.

8

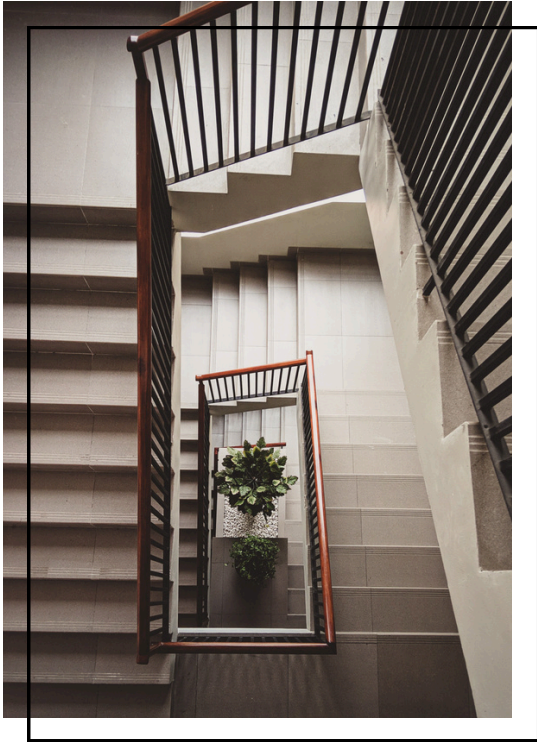
LOAN APPROVAL

The loan is only fully complete after the lender approves the loan. You will receive a final approval letter after they review your income, credit report and employment status once more.

Home owners insurance is also required before the mortgage company will finalize the loan.

9

SCHEDULE YOUR MOVE



You will want to get movers scheduled as soon as possible. Make sure to avoid scheduling the move and closing on the same day if possible. If you will be doing renovations, start getting quotes from contractors.

Make sure you set up the transfer of utilities for closing day.

10

CLOSING

Closing is the final step for you to become the legal owner of your home. You will take a final walk-through just before closing to assure that negotiated work has been completed and everything is in working order.

Be sure to confirm your wire instructions via telephone! Be prepared with your government issued photo ID, cashier's check (if needed) and any other documents required by the title company or loan officer.

Don't forget to re-key all the locks and change the garage door opener code when the property is officially yours.

Congratulations on your new home!

CUSTOMER *Testimonials*



I absolutely believe that without Jon we wouldn't have landed the home we've been looking for. He gave us insights to help craft an offer and made sure to advocate for our best interests as well. He communicated to us constantly throughout the entire process and made us feel like we were his only client. I'd recommend him to friends and family with no hesitation and if we ever have to go through this again I'd absolutely use Jon!

The Harrimans



I sincerely cannot express how amazing Jon has been in helping us find our perfect home. It was simply incredible how we could text him a home, see it, thoughtfully craft an offer, and submit it all within hours. In this market, being first to table proved to be advantageous to us and Jon made that happen. He seriously doesn't seem to stop working on behalf of his clients. I'd recommend him to my closest friends and family in a heartbeat.

The Seckers



Jonathan Croco is an absolute amazing realtor, one of the best out there. He goes far and above the call of duty to make sure his clients are very satisfied. He gets invested in what you want, be it rent, purchase or sales of properties. Please check his services out.

Olufemi Akanni

**For a comprehensive list of reviews, please visit my Facebook or Google Page!
You can also search Cummings & Co for our brokerage reviews!**

CLIENT *Resources*



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Cleaner

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SCAN ME



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SCAN ME

HOME TOURING *Checklist*

ADDRESS OF PROPERTY: _____

DATE VISITED: _____ PRICE: _____

BEDROOMS: _____ BATHROOMS: _____ SQUARE FOOT: _____

LOT SIZE: _____ YEAR BUILT: _____

SCHOOL DISTRICT: _____

CURB APPEAL

1

DISLIKE

2

NEUTRAL

3

4

5

LOVE

EXTERIOR

1

DISLIKE

2

NEUTRAL

3

4

5

LOVE

LOCATION

1

DISLIKE

2

NEUTRAL

3

4

5

LOVE

INTERIOR

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DISLIKE

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NEUTRAL

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PRICE

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DISLIKE

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NEUTRAL

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LOVE

NEIGHBORHOOD

1

DISLIKE

2

3

NEUTRAL

4

5

LOVE

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS: _____

Client *Questionnaire*

NAME: _____

PHONE: _____

EMAIL: _____

FIRST TIME HOMEBUYER:

☐ YES OR ☐ NO

CURRENTLY RENT OR OWN:

☐ Own OR ☐ RENT

LENDER: _____

MOVING TIMELINE: _____

PRE-APPROVED: ☐ YES OR ☐ NO

WHY ARE YOU BUYING? _____

my dream home

LOCATION: _____

BUDGET: _____ STYLE: _____

BR/BA: _____ LAND: _____ CENTRAL: _____

BASEMENT: _____ GARAGE: _____ RENO/TLC: _____

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS: _____

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